# Technical onboarding checklist

Genie deployment guide. Last verified 17 Oct 2026.

## 2.2 Prepare each table in Unity Catalog

### Must have

- [ ] The table is registered in Unity Catalog with a comment explaining its contents and business context.
- [ ] Every column has a business description and a self-explanatory name (`customer_lifetime_value`, not `clv`).
- [ ] Dates are stored as DATE or TIMESTAMP, not strings.

**Should have**: primary and foreign keys, and governance tags for PII and sensitivity. **Good to have**: `OPTIMIZE` unless predictive optimisation is on, and a documented freshness cadence.

```sql
COMMENT ON TABLE main.sales.orders
  IS 'One row per customer order. Refreshed daily.';

ALTER TABLE main.sales.orders
  ALTER COLUMN order_total COMMENT 'Order value in USD including tax';

-- Keys are informational in Unity Catalog; they tell Genie how tables join
ALTER TABLE main.sales.orders ALTER COLUMN order_id SET NOT NULL;
ALTER TABLE main.sales.orders ADD CONSTRAINT orders_pk PRIMARY KEY (order_id);
```

Put metadata on table and column descriptions first. Only the relevant subset is sent with each prompt, which leaves more context for the question. Avoid repeating column semantics in general instructions.